ACC ANTI-CORRUPTION COMMISSION

COMMISSION MEETING FORM

MEETING NO.	18th Commission Meeting
DATE:	16 February 2026
TIME:	09:30 AM
VENUE:	*Druk Dradhir Khang*

#	AGENDA & DISCUSSION	DECISION
1	**Update on the NACD programme – DoPE** *ED presented the final programme for the 3rd NACD, which will be graced by the Hon'ble Minister, MoESD. The half an hour programme will commence with opening remarks by the Chairperson of the ACC, followed by an address and formal launch of the DAMTSI Education Guide for ECCD and the DAMTSI Certificate Course on Ethical Values for ISM by the Hon'ble Minister. The programme will also include sharing of experiential insights on the implementation of DAMTSI initiatives by the Director of the DSE, MoESD, and the President of ISM.* *To complement the central programme and enhance its national visibility, ED apprised that Dzongkhag-level events on commemoration of Birth Anniversary of His Majesty The King will incorporate announcements highlighting that 21 February is also observed as NACD. This observance not only pays tribute to His Majesty's profound wisdom, foresight, and vision in advancing integrity as a quintessential element of Bhutanese identity but also serves as a call to action for citizens to uphold unsullied 'tha damtsi' in pursuit of a Developed Bhutan.* *ED further apprised the Commission on various build-up programmes conducted to date in collaboration with the three Regional Offices across the country. As part of these activities, the Chairperson's message on NACD will be published on the eve of the Day through the ACC website and social media platforms. Additionally, in collaboration with Denkar Getaway, a public poll comprising six questions on awareness of NACD, along with a video message featuring students from*	**Noted with following specific directives:** • **exercise caution in the use of the term 'marginalized' in official documents and communications.** • **Commissioner In-Charge to deliver the opening remarks in view of the Chairperson's participation in the 5th Zhabtog Programme for the GMC. The Commissioner In-Charge shall also make a courtesy call on the Hon'ble Minister to brief on the overall programme.** • **ascertain the suitability of Denkar Getaway's target audience vis-à-vis the youth focused theme of NACD, ensuring that any collaboration meaningfully aligns with and captures the imagination of young audiences.** • **explore the introduction of a NACD video segment through Denkar Getaway, potentially incorporating a youth rap artist on integrity and anti-corruption.** • **include a short visual segment of the DAMTSI**

	Khasadrupchu Central School, will be disseminated through Instagram and other social media platforms to broaden outreach and engagement.	**publication launch, featuring a child flipping the pages, to enhance audience appeal.** • **initiate work on reviving the original ACC theme song through collaboration with emerging young rap artists, with a aim to releasing it before the end of the current FY.** **Additionally, directed PPD to notify all staff that official documents and correspondences of the ACC shall adopt British English conventions.**
2	**Present updated technical methodology on NIA – DoPE** *EAD presented the preliminary findings of the 6th NIA, outlining the chronology, objectives, rationale for the enhanced scope, methodology, index components and weightage, sample size, and the preliminary score trend over the years.* *With 18,623 respondents (16,691 for public integrity, 427 for private integrity, and 1,505 for parliament integrity), the preliminary overall score for the 6th NIA stood at 8.22. However, upon applying favourable response deduction, the score reduced to 8.10, and further to 8.00 when incorporating the Corruption Case Index (CCI). In terms of component scores, the Public Sector Integrity Index scored 8.41, the Parliamentary Integrity Index 7.07, and the Construction Sector Index 8.84. EAD further presented comparative variations in the index scores with and without application of the CCI and sought the Commission's guidance on the exclusion of the CCI from the current NIA given that the CCI is still in the process of finalization under the AIMS framework.* *The Commission expressed concern regarding the relatively high score of the Construction Sector Index, noting that a significant proportion of corruption reports and investigations arise in this sector. It was observed that the sector's integrity safeguards remain comparatively less mature than those in the public sector, and the high score may not adequately reflect ground realities. The Commission cautioned that inclusion of the Construction Sector Index in its present form could distort the overall national integrity assessment and potentially undermine the credibility of the NIA as a robust tool for evidence-based anti-corruption interventions.*	**Decided as follows:** • **exclude the CCI from the current NIA score calculation.** • **exclude the Construction Sector Index from the current NIA and explore developing it as a standalone analytical report.** • **revert To the weightage distribution ~~to~~ that applied in the previous NIA cycle.** • **utilise the findings under the Construction Sector Index to inform and mutually enrich the ongoing piloting of the DAMTSI-BIZ framework.** • **present the NIA findings and overall framework to the ECB for constructive engagement and feedback.**

	Additionally, the Commission deliberated on the continued relevance and positioning of the NIA in light of the evolving AIMS framework, which is intended to provide a more structured and evidence-based approach to integrity assessment and intervention in the agencies. *The EAD also sought the Commission's directive on the request received from the ECB to present on the NIA and its framework.*	
3	**Update on the POC on Bank Statement Analysis, Knowledge Management, and Call Data Record Analysis – DoI, SS, & Consultant** *Kinga Rinzin, AI Project Lead, apprised the Commission on the overall progress of the AI initiatives at the ACC, which commenced on 25 March 2025 and have since evolved into a suite of integrated investigative support systems. The initiative currently comprises six core AI-enabled systems:* *i) Bank Statement Analysis (BSA) System;* *ii) Knowledge Repository System;* *iii) Call Data Record (CDR) Analysis System;* *iv) Relationship Mapping System;* *v) Operational Command Centre (O2C) System; and* *vi) AI Chatboard.* *The above initiatives are being coordinated in collaboration with a local firm, JAGGLE AI, and final-year students of GCIT as part of their Capstone Project Programme.* *The demonstration of the BSA System, currently under User Acceptance Testing (UAT), showcased its capabilities in anomaly detection, red-flag identification, explainable risk scoring, and financial pattern analysis. The system addresses the growing complexity of financial transactions and the time intensive nature of manually analysing multiple bank accounts and statements.* *The Knowledge Repository System was demonstrated using the Tanalung Case, illustrating its ability to generate structured, contextual responses on complaints, cases, and outcomes based on data maintained within the ACC. The system is designed to address institutional knowledge gaps through structured storage, retrieval, and relational mapping of case documents, while incorporating safeguards to mask sensitive information.* *The demonstrations of the CDR Analysis and Relationship Mapping Systems highlighted functionalities such as link analysis, communication*	**Noted the initiatives.**

	pattern mapping, and network visualisation to support enhanced investigative analysis. The Operational Command Centre (O2C) was presented as an integrated dashboard enabling real-time monitoring of surveillance and investigative processes. The AI Chatboard complements these systems by providing query driven insights and reporting support within a secure, role-based access environment. *The overall architecture of these AI projects are designed to serve as integrated tool within CIMS, which will be deployed in a secure on-premises environment, enabling investigators to build customised workflows within a unified and controlled platform.*	
4	**Tentative agenda for the Tripartite Meeting among the ACC, RAA, and RCSC – DoPS & PPD** *PPD presented the draft agenda items proposed by the RCSC for the upcoming Tripartite Meeting. The agenda includes:* *i)* ***Streamlining Administrative Action**: Currently, the administrative action sanctioned by agencies following RAA/ACC's decisions are inconsistent and need streamlining.* *ii)* ***Joint Advisory**: The RCSC proposes for joint advisory to deter civil servants from corruption or related activities.* *iii)* ***Strengthening Service Delivery Challenges**: Currently, data sharing among the three agencies is difficult. For instance, during gratuity claims or promotion, Integrity Assessment Report is difficult to obtain. Similarly, we have no system to check if a civil servant is under ACC investigation or acquitted.* *Similarly, the PPD presented preliminary agenda items from the ACC as follows for Commission's directives:* *i)* ***Referral and Appeal of Disciplinary Issues**: Inconsistencies in the actions taken by the agencies and RCSC on the disciplinary issues and appeal cases respectively.* *ii)* ***Revision in the parameters of the Executive Performance Dashboard**: The Performance Dashboard for Executives includes "Anti-Corruption" under Delivery Competency of the Section C on Leadership Capability Framework. This is proposed to be changed to "AIM Score" to allow effective gauging of*	**Decided to propose all except the agenda on Talent Retention and Management to be taken up at the bilateral forum.**

	the Executive concerned on their delivery of integrity and anti-corruption measures within their agencies/departments. *iii)* ***Follow up on the Talent Retention and Management****: Currently, the proposal is still under review and yet to receive a formal communication.*	
5	**Proposal from BTI on digital platform for reporting corruption, maladministration, and local injustices – LD & PPD** *LD and PPD apprised the Commission on the consultation convened by the BTI to seek feedback on the proposed digital corruption reporting platform under the project '**Women and Youth for Digital Anti-Corruption and Access to Justice**'. While acknowledging the project's alignment with broader governance objectives, LD highlighted the legal and institutional concerns associated with establishing a parallel reporting mechanism, including risks to due process, evidentiary integrity, and confidentiality of whistleblowers.* *In this regard, the team proposed formally requesting the BTI to reconsider the proposed activity and instead focus on strengthening public awareness on the ACC's existing reporting channels, as well as collaboration in areas such as research, advocacy, and training consistent with the statutory mandate.* *To this, besides the legal concerns, the Commission noted that the introduction of a parallel reporting system could create unnecessary public confusion regarding the reliability of reporting channels and may expose both institutions to unwarranted scrutiny in instances of inefficiency, delay, or abuse.*	**Directed to formally communicate the Commission's position to the BTI, firmly conveying the request to reconsider the proposed activity.**
6	**Proposal to extend the training on Elementization to Management – PPD** *PPD apprised the Commission on the request received from the management to attend the training on Elementization to Management. In this regard, PPD sought the approval of the Commission to coordinate second round of training for the management.*	**Endorsed to coordinate the second round of training for the management at the Head Office.**
7	**Report on TI CPI 2025 and way forward – PPD** *PPD presented the analysis of the TI CPI 2025 and its data sources, highlighting the emerging governance gaps reflected in the marginal score decline. These findings were noted to be broadly consistent with the trends observed in the recent NIA. In this regard, PPD apprised the Commission of the need for a deeper institutional response that goes*	**Directed PPD to present the review on the implementation of NIACS 2029-2023 and Strategic Anti-Corruption Roadmap 2021-2030.**

	beyond perception management and instead addresses structural issues such as enforcement consistency, procedural vulnerabilities, discretion risks, and integrity concerns at the service delivery level. *Accordingly, PPD outlined the following possible way forward:* • *initiate leadership briefings to align the Executive, Judiciary, Legislature, Armed Forces, and SOEs on the implications of the CPI and NIA findings;* • *convene National Governance Diagnostic Workshops to identify institutional inconsistencies, discretion risks, and assign clear ownership of reform areas;* • *engage key stakeholders through Integrity Dialogues to define shared responsibilities beyond the public sector;* • *develop a National Integrity & Governance Strategy (2026-2030), anchored in measurable indicators integrated into national performance and monitoring systems; and* • *validate the strategy prior to formal adoption and public launch to ensure whole-of-society ownership and structured implementation oversight.* *In this context, PPD presented three possible approaches for developing the strategy:* *i) an in-house ACC-led task force to ensure strong national ownership and contextual expertise;* *ii) a joint ACC-Chandler Governance Group (CGG) model combining domestic ownership with international benchmarking and external validation; and* *iii) an externally led model offering strong international optics but entailing higher financial cost and comparatively reduced national ownership.* *While the Commission agreed with the proposal in principle, it emphasized the need to first assess the progress, outcomes, and lessons learned from the previous strategy before determining the appropriate approach and sequencing the next steps.*	

8	**Proposal from IACA to host Asia Regional Expert Meeting on Measuring the Effectiveness of Anti-Corruption Agencies in Bhutan – PPD** *PPD apprised the Commission on the proposal received from the IACA to host the Third Regional Expert Meeting on Measuring the Effectiveness of Anti-Corruption Agencies (ACAs) in Bhutan from 3-5 June 2026. The meeting is part of IACA's ongoing initiative to develop a robust research methodology for assessing ACA effectiveness globally. It aims to familiarise regional ACAs with the proposed methodology, review initial findings, strengthen cooperation with national statistical offices, and deliberate on emerging issues, including transparency in political finance.* *The meeting is expected to convene over 40 anti-corruption practitioners, statistical experts, and representatives from international organisations across 23 countries in East, Southeast, and South Asia, including Bhutan. IACA has earmarked a budget of USD 80,000 to USD 100,000 to cover all meeting related costs.* *Notwithstanding this allocation, IACA has requested the ACC's support in:* • *coordinating local administrative and logistical arrangements, including accommodation, venue, catering, and transportation; and* • *facilitating visa processing for participants, including support for waiver of SDF and related processing charges.* *In view of the strategic opportunity to contribute to the evolving global discourse on measuring anti-corruption effectiveness while enhancing Bhutan's visibility and leadership in the international integrity architecture, PPD sought the Commission's approval to host the meeting. PPD further proposed exploring rescheduling the meeting to the first week of July 2026, taking into account the lean tourist season to ease logistical and cost pressures, while also being mindful of the monsoon period.*	**Endorsed the proposal with the following specific directives:** • **explore meeting dates towards the end of June 2026, taking into account the likelihood of the early monsoon season.** • **cover costs related to the working lunch during the meeting, courtesy dinner, and local transportation as part of modest hospitality.** • **facilitate waiver of the SDF for participants, while the visa ~~processing~~ fees shall be borne by the respective participants.** • **process political concurrence from the MoFAET and conduct comparative study on the costing and logistical arrangement to facilitate confirmation.**

Commissioner **Commissioner** **Chairperson**